DIGITALAIKART · EXAM PLAYBOOK SERIES

SNAP 2026

The Three-Attempt Playbook

Registration closes 25 November. Three tests, 13, 19 and 26 December. The 60-question paper, the new Ethics section, the institute matrix, the fee maths and the 46-day plan.

28	3	60	17
DAYS TO REGISTRATION CLOSE	TEST DATES	QUESTIONS IN 60 MIN	SYMBIOSIS INSTITUTES

Every date, fee, weightage and rule in this playbook is drawn from the Symbiosis International (Deemed University) SNAP 2026 bulletin and the official institute admission pages, checked on 28 October 2026.

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How to read this

Read sections 1 to 4 today and register this week. Sections 5 to 16 are the daily working part - playbooks, worked examples and a timed self-test. Sections 17 to 24 are for the weeks after the paper, when the institutes' own deadlines start arriving, and they arrive earlier than most candidates expect.

Fees, dates and weightages carry the source they came from. Where an institute has not published a figure, the playbook says so instead of guessing.

01 · THE FRAME

The five facts that decide your SNAP 2026

SNAP is not one exam in December. It is a three-week window in which you can sit the same 60-question paper up to three times, keep your best score, and walk away with a percentile that is valid for the 2027-28 academic year. Almost everything that goes wrong for candidates happens before the paper, in the registration portal, not in the exam hall.

Here are the five facts the rest of this playbook is built on.

1. **Registration closes on 25 November 2026.** After that date nothing changes - not your test city, not your test date, not your programme list. The bulletin is explicit: no changes are permitted after registration under any circumstances.
2. **The three tests are on 13, 19 and 26 December 2026.** They are three separate papers on three dates. You may sit one, two or all three, and the higher score is used for your final percentile. There is no normalisation of your score across attempts.
3. **Paying the test fee does not apply you to any programme.** The test fee is Rs 2,550 per attempt; each MBA programme you want costs a separate Rs 1,000. Candidates who skip the second fee are simply not considered for that programme - no message, no refund, no appeal.
4. **The paper is 60 questions in 60 minutes with 25% negative marking.** That is one minute per question with a penalty that rewards judgement as much as knowledge. It is among the fastest papers in the Indian MBA entrance calendar, and speed is a skill you train, not a talent you have.
5. **The exam is only half the merit score.** Every Symbiosis institute builds its final merit list as SNAP 50%, Group Exercise 10%, Personal Interaction 40%. A good score gets you the call; the interview decides the seat.

25 NOV	13 DEC	19 DEC	26 DEC	12 JAN
REGISTRATION CLOSES	TEST 1	TEST 2	TEST 3	RESULT

If you only remember one thing

A candidate who registers on 20 November with three attempts booked, two programmes paid for and a 25-day plan beats a candidate who has been reading since June but registers on 26 November. The deadline is the single largest source of lost seats in this exam.

02 · THE RESET

What changed in 2026 - and what it changes for you

SNAP 2026 is not a rerun of SNAP 2025. The test has a fourth section, a publicised early-registration benefit, and a pattern that shifts 10 of the 60 marks away from the three sections everyone practises. If your preparation material is from an earlier year, it is planning for a different paper.

The 2026 paper, section by section

Section	Questions	Marks each	Total
General English	10	1	10
Analytical and Logical Reasoning	20	1	20
Quantitative, Data Interpretation and Data Sufficiency	20	1	20
Ethics, Morality and Values (new in 2026)	10	1	10
Total	60	-	60

Source: SNAP 2026 bulletin, Section 2, and SIU's published exam pattern. Duration 60 minutes; each question has four response options; 25% negative marking applies to every incorrect answer.

Three changes that matter

1. Ethics, Morality and Values carries 10 marks

One-sixth of the paper now tests how you reason about right and wrong - not general knowledge, not current affairs. Ten marks in a 60-mark paper is the difference between a comfortable shortlist and a borderline one. It is also the section where a well-prepared candidate gains the most, because most candidates will not prepare for it at all.

2. The early-registration benefit has already passed

SIU offered early applicants access to an official SNAP AI assistant for preparation tips and mentorship sessions with previous high scorers. That window was tied to the first week of the application period, which opened on 21 August 2026. It is gone. Registering late now costs you nothing extra in fees - but it does cost you choice of test city and test date, which the bulletin says is first come, first served.

3. The paper got shorter in attention span, not in difficulty

60 questions in 60 minutes with a 0.25 penalty per wrong answer is a judgement test disguised as an aptitude test. The arithmetic is school-level. The skill being measured is deciding, in under 40 seconds, whether a question is worth your next minute.

What this means for your next 46 days

- Budget roughly one week for Ethics, Morality and Values. It is new to almost everyone, it is 10 marks, and it needs a method rather than a syllabus.
- Practise at 60 questions in 55 minutes, not 60. On test day the interface, the instruction screen and your own nerves will eat the extra five.
- Stop preparing three sections equally. Analytical and Logical Reasoning plus Quantitative together carry 40 of 60 marks; General English carries 10 and is the cheapest place to lose rank through carelessness.

03 · THE PORTAL

Registration: the walkthrough and the fee maths

The portal is not complicated, but it is unforgiving. Two fees, no edits after payment, and a photograph rule that has stopped candidates at the gate. Work through this once, slowly, on a laptop rather than a phone.

The twelve steps

1. Open snaptest.org and choose Register. Use an email address and mobile number you will still control in March 2027 - every shortlist and GE-PI call goes there.
2. Accept the terms. Read the test-date list on the same screen; you are about to choose which of 13, 19 or 26 December you sit.
3. Fill your personal details exactly as they appear on your graduation marksheet and photo ID. Name mismatches surface at document verification, months later.
4. Save and continue, then enter the OTP sent to your mobile and email.
5. Note your SNAP ID and password. This ID is the handle for every query, every payment and every admit card.
6. Pay the test fee: Rs 2,550 per test, plus applicable government taxes. If you want three attempts, you pay for three tests.
7. Select the MBA programme or programmes you want. Each one adds Rs 1,000 plus taxes.
8. Pay the programme fee. This is a second, separate transaction - not included in the test fee.
9. Upload a colour passport photograph less than six months old. It reappears on your admit card and at the centre.
10. If you belong to a reserved category, a PwD category, or the Kashmiri Migrant / Kashmiri Pandit category, upload the supporting documents now. The bulletin asks for this at registration, not later.
11. Check the summary screen line by line: name, date of birth, category, test city, test date, programme list. Then submit.
12. Save the confirmation email and the payment receipt as PDFs in one folder. Print the receipt. You will want it if a payment ever needs tracing.

The fee maths nobody does before paying

Fees are quoted before government taxes. At 18% GST, the real cost of a three-attempt, three-programme application looks like this:

Item	Base	With 18% GST
One SNAP test attempt	Rs 2,550	Rs 3,009
Three attempts (13, 19 and 26 December)	Rs 7,650	Rs 9,027
One programme registration	Rs 1,000	Rs 1,180
Three programmes	Rs 3,000	Rs 3,540
Three attempts + three programmes	Rs 10,650	Rs 12,567

Arithmetic on the published base fees (Rs 2,550 per test, Rs 1,000 per programme) at the standard 18% GST rate. SIU adds taxes as applicable; the portal shows the exact figure before you pay.

A budget that most candidates get wrong

Rs 12,567 is the full three-attempt, three-programme spend - and it is still less than one month of a Pune PG rent. Compare it against the outcome it buys: three shots at the paper with your best score counting, and three programmes in the merit queue instead of one.

What is genuinely wasteful is paying for three attempts and then preparing for one, or paying for five programme registrations you cannot name a reason for. Both happen every year.

Three registration traps worth naming

- **The demand-draft route is slower than you think.** A DD of Rs 2,550 per test must physically reach the Symbiosis Test Secretariat in Pune by 3:00 pm on 25 November. Miss it and the DD is returned. Online payment is the safer default.
- **Only a realised payment shows your admit card.** The bulletin is clear that the admit card becomes visible after payment is realised. A pending UPI mandate on 7 December is not a payment.
- **Nothing is editable after registration.** Not your city, not your date, not your programme list. The only correction channel is a query ticket raised from the portal before the deadline.

04 · THE CORE METHOD

The three-attempt strategy

Three attempts with the best score counting and no normalisation is the most under-used feature of any Indian MBA entrance exam. It is not a safety net for a bad day. Used properly, it is a way to buy information about a paper you cannot otherwise see, and to convert that information into a higher percentile in twelve days.

Why three attempts beat one careful attempt

Your percentile comes from your best score across the tests you sit. That changes the shape of the decision. In a single-attempt exam, every question is a risk you must price perfectly. In SNAP, attempt one can be a live calibration: you learn the actual difficulty of each section, the real interface, and how your 60-minute pacing holds up under invigilation - and you still keep the score.

What you learn from attempt one that no mock can teach you

- Whether the Quantitative section is arithmetic-heavy or algebra-heavy this year, and how much of it is Data Sufficiency.
- How long the interface takes to load a Data Interpretation set, and how much reading each DI set actually carries.
- Whether the Ethics questions are short value judgements or longer dilemma paragraphs - the single biggest unknown in the 2026 paper.
- Your own collapse point: the minute in the paper where your accuracy drops. Everyone has one. It is usually between minute 38 and minute 48.

Choosing how many attempts to book

Your situation	Book	Why
Preparing for CAT or XAT as well; SNAP is a secondary target	1 attempt - 13 Dec	Sit the earliest date. You get a valid score before your other exams and lose no preparation time afterwards.
SNAP is a primary target; mocks are landing near your target band	2 attempts - 13 and 19 Dec	Attempt one calibrates, attempt two converts. Six days is enough to fix pacing and question selection, not enough to rebuild fundamentals.
First serious attempt; no reliable mock data yet	3 attempts - all dates	The December 26 date is a genuine third shot. Rs 2,550 for another full paper is the cheapest mock you will ever buy.
Travel or exam-city constraints	2 attempts, non-adjacent	13 and 26 December gives you two weeks between papers and avoids the 19 December crush in metro centres.

A decision rule for the day after each attempt

1. Write down your estimated section-wise attempt count and accuracy within two hours of leaving the centre - before you discuss the paper with anyone.
2. If your estimated net score is at or above the band you set before the exam, keep the remaining attempts as insurance and prepare normally.
3. If your estimate is clearly below the band, do not spend the next six days re-reading theory. Spend them on the two things that move a score in six days: pacing drills at 55 minutes and your error log.
4. Never skip an attempt you have paid for because the previous paper 'felt bad'. Felt-bad papers are usually papers where the easy questions were hidden, and everyone else felt the same.

The honest caveat

SNAP does not publish the number of candidates per test, and Symbiosis institutes do not publish official cut-offs. Any percentile figure you see quoted as a 'cut-off' is an estimate from a coaching site, not an official number. Build your target from the composite score structure in section 15, and treat third-party percentile bands as rough company, not as a target to hit exactly.

05 · THE MATHS OF MARKS

The 60-minute paper, decoded

Sixty questions, sixty minutes, one mark for a correct answer and a quarter mark off for a wrong one. Those three numbers together decide how you should behave in the hall, and the arithmetic is more interesting than it looks.

What the negative marking actually means

With four options and a penalty of 0.25, a completely blind guess is worth slightly more than zero, not less. The expected value of a blind guess is 0.25 x 1 - 0.75 x 0.25 = +0.06 marks. Eliminate one option and it rises to 0.33 - 0.17 = +0.17 marks. This is why 'never guess' is bad advice in SNAP: the penalty is set below the neutral point of one-third.

Expected net score for a candidate who attempts all 60 questions

Accuracy on attempted questions	Correct	Wrong	Net score
50%	30	30	22.5
60%	36	24	30.0
70%	42	18	37.5
80%	48	12	45.0
90%	54	6	52.5

Net = correct - 0.25 x wrong, assuming all 60 questions attempted. Every five percentage points of accuracy is worth roughly 3.75 marks - which is why accuracy work beats new-topic work in the final month.

The pacing plan that survives contact with the paper

Section	Qs	Marks	Plan (minutes)	Rule of thumb
General English	10	10	9	Fastest section. Do it first, cold, and bank the marks.
Analytical and Logical Reasoning	20	20	21	Two passes. Long puzzles go to pass two or get dropped.
Quantitative, DI and DS	20	20	23	Data Sufficiency first - they are often the cheapest marks in the paper.
Ethics, Morality and Values	10	10	5	No calculation. Read, decide, move. Never return.
Buffer	-	-	2	Reserved for interface lag and one stubborn question.

Total 60 minutes. SIU's guidelines state that you may attempt sections in any order, so this sequence is yours to change - but fix one sequence in your mocks and keep it on test day.

The two-pass method

- **Pass one:** every question you can finish in under 45 seconds. Do not read the whole paper first; that is a 3-minute habit with no payoff at 60 questions.
- **Pass two:** everything left, in descending order of how close you were. A question where you had already eliminated two options is worth more than a fresh one.
- **Never** leave a question untouched at the end. With a 0.25 penalty on four options, a blank is a guaranteed zero against a slightly positive expectation.

Arithmetic shortcuts worth rehearsing

Percentages as fractions: 12.5% is one-eighth, 16.67% is one-sixth, 37.5% is three-eighths. Recognising the fraction is faster than long division under time pressure.

Ratio scaling for Data Interpretation: compute one value per chart properly, then scale the rest. Reading every bar precisely is the most common time leak in DI.

Approximation before calculation: in a 60-second question, the answer options usually differ enough that two significant figures are sufficient.

06 · THE AUDIT

Diagnostic: where you stand today

Before you build a plan, you need one honest measurement. This audit takes fifteen minutes and needs no mock test. Score each statement 0, 1 or 2 - 0 for 'not true', 1 for 'partly', 2 for 'yes, reliably'.

#	Statement	Score
1	I have registered on snaptest.org and paid for the attempts I intend to take.	0 / 1 / 2
2	I have paid the programme fee for every programme I actually want.	0 / 1 / 2
3	I can name, without checking, the four sections of the SNAP 2026 paper and their mark weights.	0 / 1 / 2
4	I have taken at least one full 60-question mock under a clock.	0 / 1 / 2
5	I know my section-wise accuracy from that mock, not just my total.	0 / 1 / 2
6	I can solve a Data Sufficiency question without calculating the answer.	0 / 1 / 2
7	I have a written formula sheet I can reproduce from memory.	0 / 1 / 2
8	I have read anything at all about the Ethics, Morality and Values section.	0 / 1 / 2

#	Statement	Score
9	I have a fixed section order and a minute budget for the paper.	0 / 1 / 2
10	I know which institute programmes I am targeting and their registration deadlines.	0 / 1 / 2

Reading your score

Score	What it means	Do this first
17-20	You are organised and your preparation has structure. The gap is conversion, not knowledge.	Move straight to section 14 and start the three-mock-a-week cycle.
11-16	The intent is there, the system is not. You will lose marks to pacing and to the new Ethics section.	Fix items 5, 6 and 8 this week, then section 13.
5-10	You are inside the deadline but outside a plan. Every week of drift costs roughly 4 marks.	Register today. Then the 18-day plan in section 13.
0-4	You are at the start, which is fine - 46 days is enough if you start now.	Register, book three attempts, and take one diagnostic mock before Sunday.

Why items 1, 2 and 10 sit in a preparation audit

Three of the ten statements are administrative, and they are the three that disqualify candidates outright. A candidate who scores 16 on preparation and 0 on registration has no application in the queue. The audit is deliberately blunt about this: in SNAP, paperwork is not a distraction from preparation, it is the first section of it.

Two numbers to write down now

Whatever your score, write two numbers on the first page of your notebook: the net score you believe you can reach by 13 December, and the net score you would be satisfied with on 26 December. Everything in the plan is measured against the first number, and the second is what stops you from skipping a paid attempt because one paper felt bad.

07 · SECTION PLAYBOOK

General English: 10 questions, 10 marks

Ten questions in a 60-question paper looks small. It is one-sixth of your marks and, for most engineering and commerce candidates, the fastest ten marks on the paper - if you stop treating it as a reading comprehension test.

What to expect

SNAP's General English has historically tested vocabulary in context, grammar and usage, sentence completion, para-jumbles and short reading passages. At 10 questions the paper cannot afford long passages, so expect short extracts of two to four sentences rather than page-length reading.

The 9-minute method

1. Answer vocabulary and grammar items first. They are self-contained and do not depend on reading anything else.
2. For sentence completion, read the whole sentence before looking at the options. Two options usually fit the blank in isolation; only one fits the sentence's logic.
3. For para-jumbles, find the opener first - the sentence that introduces a noun without referring back to one - then the pair that must sit together.

4 For a passage, read the question stems before the passage. With three or four questions per extract, knowing what you are hunting cuts reading time by half.

Where the marks actually leak

Two habits cost most candidates 2 of the 10 marks here. The first is perfectionism: re-reading a passage to be certain, when the answer is already clear. The second is over-correction: changing a first answer on a grammar item because it 'sounds wrong' in a dialect you speak rather than in standard written English.

A 10-minute daily drill that works

Take one editorial paragraph a day - 120 to 150 words - and do three things with it: underline every connector (however, therefore, although, consequently), write its argument in one sentence, and note two words you would not have used yourself. That is ten minutes. Over 40 days it is 40 paragraphs of real prose, which is more varied than any vocabulary list.

08 · SECTION PLAYBOOK

Analytical and Logical Reasoning: 20 questions

Twenty marks, and the section where the difference between a 12 and an 18 is almost entirely a question-selection decision made in the first four minutes.

The families of question you will meet

- Arrangements: linear, circular, and double-row seating with mixed facing directions.
- Grouping and selection: teams or committees built under constraints.
- Blood relations and direction sense, often disguised inside a short puzzle.
- Syllogisms and logical deduction: statement-conclusion, assumption, and strengthen-weaken arguments.
- Series and coding: number, letter and symbol series, plus coding-decoding.
- Puzzles with distribution: floors, boxes, days of the week, schedules.

The 21-minute allocation

Two passes, ruthlessly. Pass one takes every question you can settle in under 60 seconds: syllogisms, series, coding, direction sense, simple blood relations. That is usually 9 to 12 questions. Pass two takes the arrangements and distribution puzzles, and you pick them by how many constraints they carry - a puzzle with four clues and five slots is cheaper than one with seven clues and six slots.

Question type	Target time	When to skip
Coding-decoding, series	35-45 sec	Never - these are the cheapest marks
Syllogism / deduction	45-60 sec	If two options look identical, move on
Blood relations, direction	50-70 sec	If the family tree needs more than five people
Linear / circular arrangement	90-120 sec	If two clues are negative ('A is not next to B')
Distribution puzzle (floors, days)	100-140 sec	If the first two clues do not fix a single position

The habit that lifts this section fastest

Draw. Every arrangement and distribution question should have a diagram within fifteen seconds - a line, a circle, a grid. Candidates who try to hold constraints in their head spend 40 extra seconds per question and still get it wrong. The paper gives you rough sheets; use them.

09 · SECTION PLAYBOOK

Quantitative, DI and Data Sufficiency: 20 questions

This is the section with the widest gap between what candidates fear and what the paper actually asks. SNAP quantitative is arithmetic-led: percentages, ratios, averages, time-speed-distance, time and work, profit and loss, and simple interest. Not calculus, not heavy algebra.

Read the section name carefully

The 2026 section is called Quantitative, Data Interpretation and Data Sufficiency - all three in one 20-question block. That matters for strategy: Data Sufficiency questions ask whether the data given is enough to answer, not what the answer is. You can often solve them without computing anything, which makes them the best marks-per-second in the entire paper.

How to work a Data Sufficiency question

1. Read the question stem and decide precisely what single value or relation is being asked for.
2. Test statement one alone. Do not use anything from statement two. If it is sufficient, the answer is either 'one alone' or 'each alone'.
3. Test statement two alone, ignoring statement one.
4. Only if both fail alone, combine them. Most wasted time in DS comes from combining too early.

The 23-minute allocation

Block	Likely questions	Minutes	Approach
Data Sufficiency	4-6	5	No calculation. Test each statement alone.
Arithmetic (percentage, ratio, average)	5-7	8	Fraction equivalents; answer options are usually far apart.
Data Interpretation (1-2 sets)	4-6	7	One precise read per chart, then scale. Skip the set with the ugliest numbers.
Time-speed-work, profit-loss, interest	3-4	3	Formula recall, no derivation.

One page of formulas is enough

Write the twenty formulas you actually use - percentage change, successive percentage change, average speed for two equal distances (2xy/(x+y)), work rates added as fractions, compound interest for two years, simple interest, profit on cost versus markup on price - on a single sheet. Rehearse writing that sheet from memory twice a week. In the hall you are recalling a page you have written forty times, not searching a textbook.

10 · THE CHEAPEST MARKS

Data Sufficiency: six worked examples

Data Sufficiency questions give you a question and two statements, and ask whether the statements are enough to answer it - not what the answer is. The standard options in this format are the same in almost every exam that uses it, so learn them once.

The five standard options

(A) Statement 1 alone is sufficient, but statement 2 alone is not.
(B) Statement 2 alone is sufficient, but statement 1 alone is not.
(C) Both statements together are sufficient, but neither alone is.
(D) Each statement alone is sufficient.
(E) Statements 1 and 2 together are still not sufficient.

The one rule that saves time: test each statement in isolation first. Bringing in statement 2 while testing statement 1 is the most common error in this format, and it produces the wrong letter even when your arithmetic is perfect.

Example 1. Is x greater than y?

(1) $x = y + 4$ (2) $y > 0$

Reasoning: Statement 1 alone settles it: x is always 4 more than y, so $x > y$ regardless of the value of y. Statement 2 tells you nothing about x. Answer: (A).

Example 2. What is the value of the integer n?

(1) n is a prime number less than 10 (2) n is odd

Reasoning: Statement 1 leaves 2, 3, 5, 7 - not sufficient. Statement 2 leaves every odd integer - not sufficient. Together, 3, 5 and 7 survive, so still not one value. Answer: (E).

Example 3. A shop sells a shirt at a discount. What is the selling price?

(1) The marked price is Rs 1,200 (2) Two successive discounts of 20% and 10% were given

Reasoning: Each statement alone gives you only half the picture. Together: 1200 x 0.8 x 0.9 = Rs 864, a single value. Answer: (C).

Example 4. Is the number k divisible by 6?

(1) k is divisible by 2 (2) k is divisible by 3

Reasoning: Divisible by 2 alone: 4 is not divisible by 6. Divisible by 3 alone: 9 is not. Together, divisible by both 2 and 3 means divisible by 6. Answer: (C).

Example 5. How many students are in the class?

(1) The average age of the class is 15 years (2) The total of all ages is 450 years

Reasoning: An average alone fixes nothing. A total alone fixes nothing. Together: 450 / 15 = 30 students - one value. Answer: (C).

Example 6. What is the value of the two-digit number N?

(1) The sum of its digits is 9 (2) The number is a multiple of 7

Reasoning: Statement 1: 18, 27, 36, 45, 54, 63, 72, 81, 90 - many. Statement 2: 14, 21, 28, ... many. Together the candidates are 63 only, since 63 has digit sum 9 and is a multiple of 7. Answer: (C).

The 30-second habit that makes DS profitable

For every DS question, before touching the statements, write down what a single value would look like - 'one number', 'a yes or no', 'a ratio'. If a statement can only produce a range, a relationship or a set, it is not sufficient, and you know that without computing anything.

11 · SECTION PLAYBOOK

Ethics, Morality and Values: the new 10 marks

This is the section with no past papers, no coaching consensus and 10 marks of the 60. It is also the most winnable section in the paper, because it tests a way of thinking rather than a syllabus you must finish.

What is verified, and what is not

What is verified: SNAP 2026 added a section called Ethics, Morality and Values worth 10 questions and 10 marks, with one mark per correct answer and the same 25% negative marking as the rest of the paper. What is not published: a detailed topic list. Neither the SNAP bulletin nor SIU's pattern page carries a chapter-wise syllabus for this section, so anyone selling you a 'complete Ethics syllabus' is inventing it. The reliable inputs are SIU's own sample material and the official mock tests on snaptest.org.

The four question shapes to expect

- **The value judgement:** a short scenario, four responses, one that reflects a defensible ethical principle rather than convenience.
- **The stakeholder question:** who is affected, and whose interest the correct option protects when interests conflict.
- **The integrity question:** what a professional does when honesty is expensive.
- **The definitional question:** distinguishing related ideas - ethics from legality, morality from custom, accountability from blame.

A method that works on almost every item

1. Identify the decision-maker and the duty they hold - a manager's duty to employees differs from a friend's duty to a friend.
2. Ask what the option does to the person with least power in the scenario. Options that quietly transfer cost to the weakest party are usually the distractors.
3. Prefer the option that is transparent and reversible. Concealment, even when it looks efficient, is almost always the wrong answer.
4. Reject absolutes: 'always', 'never', 'under no circumstances' rarely describe ethical judgement, which is contextual by nature.
5. Distrust the option that is merely legal. The section is called Ethics, not Compliance - legality is the floor, not the answer.

The one-week Ethics plan

Days 1-2: write out, in your own words, the difference between ethics, morality, values, law and etiquette. If you can explain each in two sentences, the definitional questions are already yours.

Days 3-4: take ten real news stories with an ethical dimension and write the strongest argument for both sides in three lines each. This trains the reasoning the section is testing.

Days 5-6: sit SIU's official mock and any sample Ethics items, and log why each wrong option was wrong - the distractors repeat the same three patterns.

Day 7: rehearse the five-step method above on 20 fresh items against the clock, five minutes for ten questions.

Why five minutes, not ten

There is no calculation here, so there is no reason to spend more than 30 seconds on any item. Ten questions in five minutes leaves you the buffer that the Quantitative section will otherwise eat.

12 · THE NEW SECTION

Ethics question bank: 20 dilemmas

The Ethics, Morality and Values section has no past papers, so the only reliable practice is reasoning through dilemmas out loud. Below are twenty situations drawn from workplaces, campuses and family businesses. For each, the model reasoning is what a strong answer does - not the only defensible answer.

Work through five a day. Write your answer before reading the model - the value is in the disagreement between the two.

1. Your manager asks you to present last quarter's numbers without mentioning that two large orders were cancelled in the final week.
Model reasoning: Transparency about material facts, offered constructively: present the numbers as asked, and add the cancellations as a line the audience needs to interpret them. Concealment that changes the meaning of a figure is misrepresentation, however accurate the figure itself.

2. A vendor sends a festival gift worth Rs 6,000 to your home. Your company has no written policy on gifts.
Model reasoning: Absence of a policy is not permission. Disclose it, return or hand over the gift to a common pool, and ask for a written policy. The test is whether the relationship could influence a future purchase decision - and it could.

3. You discover that a teammate's project report contains data copied from a competitor's public filing without attribution.
Model reasoning: Raise it with the teammate first, in private, and give them the chance to correct it. If they do not, escalate. Attribution is not a formality: uncredited copying in a client deliverable exposes the firm, not just the individual.

4. A close friend in your team is underperforming and will be appraised by you this month.
Model reasoning: Declare the conflict and ask for the appraisal to be reassigned. If that is impossible, appraise on documented evidence and share the basis with your friend before the meeting. Friendship is not disqualifying; concealing it is.

5. Your company's product has a defect that affects 2% of users. Fixing it will delay a launch that carries your annual bonus.
Model reasoning: Disclose and fix. The relevant question is harm to the 2%, not the size of the majority. A bonus is a private cost; a defect that harms users is a public one, and the asymmetry decides the case.

6. During a group interview exercise, another candidate makes a factual claim you know is wrong, and correcting it would make you look stronger.
Model reasoning: Correct the fact, not the person, and give them room to respond. The exercise is observing conduct under pressure; humiliating a peer scores worse than being right.

7. You are asked to write a recommendation for a student you barely know, because a senior colleague has requested it.
Model reasoning: Decline to write what you cannot honestly support, and say why. Offer an alternative - a factual verification of their record, or a referral to someone who taught them. A false recommendation transfers risk to whoever relies on it.

8. A client asks you to backdate an invoice so it falls in the previous financial year.
Model reasoning: Refuse. Backdating a document to alter its tax period is not a service decision; it is falsification. Offer the legitimate alternatives - a credit note, or an invoice dated correctly with the work described accurately.

9. Your team's sales target was met only because a colleague counted orders that were later cancelled.
Model reasoning: Raise it before the numbers are reported upward. The colleague may be under pressure, so the first conversation is about correcting the figure, not about blame. Reporting inflated numbers converts one person's error into an organisational lie.

10. You are offered a job at a firm your current employer is negotiating with, and you hold information relevant to those negotiations.
Model reasoning: Disclose the offer and step back from anything touching the negotiation. The obligation is to remove yourself from the conflict, not merely to keep quiet about it.

11. A junior colleague asks you to approve an expense claim that is slightly inflated because 'everyone does it'.
Model reasoning: Decline and explain the consequence - audit, recovery, disciplinary record - without moralising. Normalised small fraud is how controls fail, and your approval is the control.

12. Your startup's investor asks for a projection you believe is unachievable, and the funding round depends on it.
Model reasoning: Give the honest projection with the assumptions attached, and show what would make the higher number achievable. Investors price risk; they do not need optimism they cannot verify.

13. A newspaper offers to publish a story about your company's safety record if you confirm a detail you know is out of date.
Model reasoning: Correct the record on the facts, and let the story run. Attempting to suppress an accurate report is a larger reputational risk than the report itself.

14. In an exam, you notice a friend copying. Reporting them will end their placement eligibility.
Model reasoning: The honest answer accepts the difficulty: the rule exists to protect everyone who did not copy. A proportionate response is to ask them to stop, and to follow the institution's process rather than deciding the punishment yourself.

15. Your employer asks you to run a marketing campaign that is legal but targets first-time borrowers with a product whose charges are hard to understand.
Model reasoning: Legality is the floor. If the charges are hard to understand, the campaign depends on misunderstanding, which makes it misleading regardless of compliance. Propose clear disclosure and measure the effect on conversion honestly.

16. You are the only person who knows a colleague has been quietly covering for a manager's repeated errors.
Model reasoning: The colleague is absorbing a cost that belongs to the manager. Raise the pattern with evidence, protect the colleague from retaliation, and fix the process rather than the person.

17. A family business asks you to keep two sets of accounts, one for the bank and one for internal use.
Model reasoning: Refuse. Dual books are not an accounting convenience; they are the mechanism of fraud and the fastest route to personal liability for whoever maintains them.

18. You are asked to interview for a role where the preferred candidate has already been chosen, and the process is only for form.
Model reasoning: Either decline to participate or say plainly that the process is not genuine. Running a sham process spends other people's time and hope, and it teaches the organisation that process is theatre.

19. Your team wins a contract partly because of a reference you gave that overstated the team's experience.
Model reasoning: Correct the record with the client before the work starts, and accept the consequence. An overstated reference becomes a delivery failure with the client's name on it.

20. You are asked, in an interview, to name a weakness. The honest answer may cost you the seat.
Model reasoning: Give a real weakness with evidence of what you have changed. Interviews are testing self-awareness, and a rehearsed strength-in-disguise answers a different question than the one asked.

How this transfers to the paper

SNAP's Ethics items are multiple choice, so you will not write reasoning - you will recognise it. The patterns above repeat: prefer disclosure to concealment, the affected party to the powerful one, the specific duty to the convenient outcome, and process to personal judgement about punishment.

13 · THE PLAN

The 46-day plan: 28 October to 13 December

Forty-six days from today to the first test. Three phases: build the base, convert it into marks, then taper. The plan assumes two to three focused hours on weekdays and one longer block at the weekend. If you have more time, add mocks, not new topics.

Phase	Dates	Days	What it is for	Weekly output
Build	28 Oct - 17 Nov	21	Section fundamentals, formula sheet, Ethics groundwork	2 sectionals + 1 full mock per week
Convert	18 Nov - 1 Dec	14	Pacing, question selection, error log review	3 full mocks per week + full analysis
Taper	2 - 13 Dec	12	Speed under fatigue, exam-day rehearsal, no new material	2 full mocks + 1 light day before each test

Phase 1 - build, 28 October to 17 November

- **Week 1 (28 Oct - 3 Nov):** register on the portal and pay for your attempts and programmes. Sit one diagnostic full mock with no preparation, and record your section-wise attempt count and accuracy. Write your formula sheet from memory once.
- **Week 2 (4 - 10 Nov):** Quant arithmetic and Data Sufficiency, 45 minutes a day. Two 20-question LR sectionals. Start the Ethics week from section 9 alongside.
- **Week 3 (11 - 17 Nov):** Data Interpretation sets, one per day, timed at seven minutes. One full mock. Begin paragraph jumbles and vocabulary-in-context drills.
- Every week: one full mock, analysed within 24 hours. An unanalysed mock is entertainment.

Phase 2 - convert, 18 November to 1 December

- Three full mocks a week, each at 55 minutes rather than 60. You are training to finish early, not to finish on time.
- After each mock, re-attempt only the questions you got wrong in under 60 seconds each. If you cannot solve a wrong question in 60 seconds on review, it is a knowledge gap, not a speed problem - log it separately.
- Fix one pacing habit per week. Week 4: never spend more than 90 seconds on a single question. Week 5: always leave the last two minutes for unanswered items.
- Register for anything still unpaid by 24 November. Nothing changes after the 25th.

Phase 3 - taper, 2 to 13 December

- Two full mocks in the first week, at the same clock time as your allotted slot if you know it.
- Stop learning new topics on 6 December. From that point you are rehearsing, not studying.
- The day before each test: one 20-question mixed set, the formula sheet, the Ethics method, and sleep. No full mock.
- Between tests, do not restart the syllabus. Review the error log, sit one sectional in your weakest section, and keep the clock habit alive.

If you are starting late - the 18-day plan

Registration closes 25 November and test one is 13 December: 18 days. This plan is for that candidate.

Days 1-2: register, pay, and sit one diagnostic mock. Days 3-8: Data Sufficiency and arithmetic in the morning, LR sectionals in the evening, Ethics method in the last 30 minutes. Days 9-14: six full mocks, one every other day, each analysed the same day. Days 15-17: two mocks at exam clock time, formula sheet twice a day, no new topics. Day 18: rest, sleep, travel to the centre.

Eighteen days of mocks and error logs beats eighteen days of reading. It is not close.

14 · THE FEEDBACK LOOP

The mock protocol and the error log

Most candidates take mocks. Very few extract anything from them, because they score the paper and move on. The protocol below takes 25 minutes after each mock and is the highest-return activity in the entire plan.

The 25-minute review

1. **Minute 0-3:** record the numbers. Attempted, correct, wrong, left blank, net score, and the section each question came from.
2. **Minute 3-10:** classify every wrong answer into one of four buckets - concept gap, calculation slip, misread question, or ran out of time.
3. **Minute 10-18:** re-solve the time-out questions with no clock. If you solve them easily, your problem is selection, not ability.
4. **Minute 18-25:** write one sentence in the log: the single change you will make in the next mock. One, not five.

The log sheet

Mock	Date	Attempted	Correct	Wrong	Net	Main leak	One change
01	____	___	___	___	___	_____	_____
02	____	___	___	___	___	_____	_____
03	____	___	___	___	___	_____	_____
04	____	___	___	___	___	_____	_____
05	____	___	___	___	___	_____	_____
06	____	___	___	___	___	_____	_____

Print six copies, or copy the grid into a notebook. Fill it in by hand - the act of writing the leak is what makes the next mock different.

Three rules for using mocks honestly

- Take mocks at a fixed time of day, in one sitting, on a laptop or desktop. SNAP is a computer-based test; paper practice trains a different rhythm.
- Do not pause. A paused mock teaches you that time is negotiable. It is not.
- Never take a mock the day before a real test. Fatigue on test day costs more marks than one extra paper adds.

15 · ONE PAGE, FORTY TIMES

The formula card

Write this page out from memory twice a week until the paper. The point is not the formulas - it is that recalling a page you have written forty times is faster than searching a textbook you read once.

Topic	What you need
Percentage	Change = (new - old) / old x 100. Successive change of a% then b% = a + b + ab/100. If price rises 25%, consumption must fall 20% to hold spend.
Ratio and proportion	If a:b = 3:5, write 3x and 5x and solve for x. Duplicate ratio a2:b2, sub-duplicate a:b under a root.
Average	Average = sum / count. If one item is removed, new average = (old sum - item) / (n - 1). Weighted average = sum of (value x weight) / sum of weights.
Profit and loss	Profit% = profit / cost price x 100. Selling price = cost x (100 + profit%) / 100. Discount% is always on marked price, never on cost.
Simple and compound interest	SI = P x R x T / 100. CI for 2 years = P[(1 + R/100) squared - 1]. Difference between CI and SI for 2 years = P(R/100) squared.
Time, speed, distance	Distance = speed x time. km/h to m/s: multiply by 5/18. Average speed for equal distances = 2xy / (x + y). Train crossing a pole: length / speed; crossing a platform: (length + platform) / speed.
Time and work	Work rate = 1 / days. Together: 1/a + 1/b. If A is twice as fast as B, A takes half the time. Wages split in the ratio of work done.
Mixtures	Alligation: (cheaper quantity / dearer quantity) = (dearer price - mean) / (mean - cheaper price).
Permutation and combination	nPr = n! / (n - r)!. nCr = n! / [r!(n - r)!]. Arrangements of a word with repeats: n! / (product of repeated factorials).
Probability	P = favourable / total. P(not A) = 1 - P(A). Independent events multiply; mutually exclusive events add.
Number properties	Divisibility: by 3 if digit sum divisible by 3; by 4 if last two digits divisible by 4; by 8 if last three digits divisible by 8; by 9 if digit sum divisible by 9; by 11 if alternating digit sum difference is 0 or a multiple of 11.
Approximation	12.5% = 1/8, 16.67% = 1/6, 20% = 1/5, 25% = 1/4, 33.3% = 1/3, 37.5% = 3/8, 62.5% = 5/8, 66.7% = 2/3, 75% = 3/4.

Three things that are not on the card, and matter more

Read the question twice before calculating. In a 60-second question, a misread costs the full 60 seconds plus the mark.

Check the answer against the options before writing it down. Options that differ by a factor of ten usually mean a unit slip.

If two options are numerically close and you are short of time, the answer is usually the one your estimate supports - approximation beats a rushed exact calculation.

16 · REHEARSE THE CLOCK

Self-test: 25 questions, 25 minutes

Sit this as a single block with a timer. Twenty-five questions in twenty-five minutes, in the proportions of the real paper - five English, six reasoning, eight quantitative and Data Sufficiency, six Ethics. The answer key with reasoning follows the questions; do not read ahead.

Mark yourself with the real penalty: one mark for a correct answer, a quarter mark off for a wrong one, nothing for a blank. Your net score out of 25 tells you more than the raw count.

General English

1. The committee's final report was terse, running to just two pages.

(a) verbose (b) concise (c) evasive (d) inaccurate

2. Despite the new evidence, he remained ___ that the plan would fail.

(a) sanguine (b) adamant (c) indifferent (d) tentative

3. Arrange the sentences into a coherent paragraph.

A. But the city's water supply has not kept pace.
B. The population has grown by nearly a third in a decade.
C. The result is a daily dependence on tankers.
D. Planners underestimated how quickly demand would rise.

(a) BADC (b) ABCD (c) BDAC (d) CABD

4. One of the reasons the project failed ___ that nobody owned the timeline.

(a) were (b) was (c) have been (d) are

5. A short passage: 'The firm's profits rose for the sixth consecutive quarter, but its headcount fell by 400. Analysts noted that the gains came largely from selling assets rather than from operations.' Which conclusion is best supported?

(a) The firm is growing operationally. (b) The profit growth may not be sustainable. (c) The firm will cut more jobs. (d) Asset sales were unprofitable.

Analytical and Logical Reasoning

6. Find the next number: 3, 7, 15, 31, 63, ___

(a) 95 (b) 119 (c) 127 (d) 131

7. In a certain code, MOUSE is written as NPVTF. How is CHAIR written?

(a) DIBJS (b) DIBIS (c) BGHQ (d) DHCJS

8. Pointing to a photograph, Ravi said, 'She is the daughter of my grandfather's only son.' How is the girl related to Ravi?

(a) Cousin (b) Niece (c) Sister (d) Aunt

9. All pens are books. Some books are red. Conclusions: I. Some pens are red. II. Some books are pens.

(a) Only I follows (b) Only II follows (c) Both follow (d) Neither follows

10. A man walks 5 km north, turns right and walks 3 km, then turns right and walks 5 km. Where is he relative to his starting point?

(a) 3 km east (b) 3 km west (c) 5 km south (d) At the starting point

11. Five people A, B, C, D and E sit in a row facing north. A is at the extreme left. C is second to the right of A. E is at the extreme right. B is not adjacent to A. Who sits in the middle?

(a) B (b) C (c) D (d) E

Quantitative, Data Interpretation and Data Sufficiency

12. A shirt marked at Rs 1,200 is sold after two successive discounts of 20% and 10%. What is the selling price?

(a) Rs 840 (b) Rs 864 (c) Rs 900 (d) Rs 960

13. The average of 11 numbers is 30. If the number 40 is removed, what is the average of the remaining numbers?

(a) 28 (b) 29 (c) 30 (d) 31

14. A can finish a job in 12 days and B in 18 days. Working together, in how many days will they finish it?

(a) 6 (b) 7.2 (c) 7.5 (d) 8

15. A 150-metre train travelling at 54 km/h crosses a pole in how many seconds?

(a) 8 (b) 10 (c) 12 (d) 15

16. An article bought for Rs 400 is sold for Rs 460. What is the profit percentage?

(a) 12% (b) 15% (c) 18% (d) 20%

17. Two numbers are in the ratio 3:5. If 10 is added to each, the ratio becomes 5:7. What is the sum of the two numbers?

(a) 32 (b) 40 (c) 48 (d) 56

18. Is x greater than y?
(1) x = y + 4
(2) y > 0

(a) 1 alone (b) 2 alone (c) both together (d) each alone (e) neither

19. What is the value of the integer n?
(1) n is a prime less than 10
(2) n is odd

(a) 1 alone (b) 2 alone (c) both together (d) each alone (e) neither

Ethics, Morality and Values

20. A manager learns that a colleague inflated a client report to meet a deadline. The manager's strongest first step is to:

(a) report the colleague to HR immediately (b) raise it privately with the colleague and require correction (c) ignore it, since the client accepted the report (d) quietly correct the numbers without telling anyone

21. Which statement best distinguishes ethics from law?

(a) Law is stricter than ethics (b) Ethics is a matter of personal taste (c) An action can be legal and still unethical (d) Ethics applies only to professionals

22. A vendor whose contract is up for renewal sends you an expensive gift. The most defensible response is to:

(a) accept it, as refusing would damage the relationship (b) accept and mention it later if asked (c) decline or disclose it, and ask for a written policy (d) accept it and award the contract on merit alone

23. An employee discovers the company is dumping waste illegally. Their duty is best described as:

(a) loyalty to the employer above all (b) reporting through internal channels first, then externally if unresolved (c) resigning quietly (d) waiting for a regulator to notice

24. You are asked to write a recommendation for a student you cannot honestly praise. The ethical course is to:

(a) write a generic letter praising 'energy and enthusiasm' (b) decline, and explain what you can and cannot attest to (c) refuse without explanation (d) write it, because the student needs a job

25. 'Integrity' in a manager's daily work most nearly means:

(a) never making mistakes (b) following every rule exactly (c) saying the same thing to every audience (d) doing what is right when it is costly and unwatched

Answer key, with reasoning

Q	Ans	Why
1	b	Terse means brief and to the point. 'Verbose' is its opposite.
2	b	Adamant - unshakeable in a belief. Sanguine is optimistic, the opposite of the sentence's logic.
3	a	BADC: population grew, supply did not keep pace, planners underestimated, hence tankers.
4	b	The subject is 'one', singular, so 'was'.
5	b	Profits driven by asset sales rather than operations do not repeat indefinitely.
6	c	Each term is double the previous plus one: 63 x 2 + 1 = 127.
7	a	Each letter shifts one forward: C-H-A-I-R becomes D-I-B-J-S.
8	c	Grandfather's only son is Ravi's father; his daughter is Ravi's sister.
9	b	Some books are pens converts from 'all pens are books'. No link exists between pens and red.
10	a	Net displacement is 3 km east; the two 5 km legs cancel.
11	b	Positions 1 to 5: A=1, C=3, E=5, D=2, B=4. Middle is C.
12	b	1200 x 0.8 x 0.9 = Rs 864.
13	b	Total 330; minus 40 gives 290 over 10 numbers = 29.
14	b	1/12 + 1/18 = 5/36, so 36/5 = 7.2 days.
15	b	54 km/h = 15 m/s; 150 / 15 = 10 seconds.
16	b	Profit 60 on cost 400 = 15%.
17	b	3x and 5x; (3x+10)/(5x+10) = 5/7 gives x = 5, so 15 and 25; sum 40.
18	a	Statement 1 fixes x as 4 more than y, so x > y always.
19	e	Both together still leave 3, 5 and 7.
20	b	Correction first, escalation if it does not happen. Jumping to HR or silently fixing both remove the colleague's chance to act.
21	c	Legality is the floor; the Ethics section repeatedly tests cases where the two diverge.
22	c	Disclosure or refusal plus a request for policy. Accepting and 'awarding on merit' leaves the conflict unmanaged.
23	b	Internal channels first, external only if unresolved. Silence and resignation transfer the harm to others.
24	b	Decline and state what you can attest to. Vague praise is a misrepresentation with better manners.
25	d	Integrity is conduct under cost and without observation - not rule-following or consistency of message.

How to use your score

18 or more net out of 25 with time to spare: your problem is not knowledge. Move to pacing and the Ethics bank in section 12.

12 to 17: identify which block cost you the most marks and give it the next week. Do not revise what you already got right.

Below 12: you have a fundamentals gap, not a speed gap. Go back to the section playbooks before taking another timed set.

17 · THE MAP

The institute matrix: 17 institutes, 32 programmes

One entrance test, 17 institutes across six cities, 32 MBA programmes. The single most useful thing you can do this week is understand that each institute runs its own clock after the result - and some programme registration deadlines fall before the result is even declared.

Where the deadlines are already published

Institute (city)	Programme registration closes	Shortlist	GE-PI dates
SIBM Pune	12 Dec 2026	19 Jan 2027	3-7 and 10-14 Feb 2027
SIIB, Pune	18 Dec 2026, 23:59	22 Jan 2027	5-7 and 12-14 Feb 2027
SCMHRD, Pune	12 Dec 2026 *	21 Jan 2027 *	2-4 and 9-12 Feb 2027 *
SIMS, Pune	11 Jan 2027	14 Jan 2027	29-31 Jan and 6-7 Feb 2027 (online)
SICSR, Pune	16 Jan 2027	21 Jan 2027	7-9 and 13-14 Feb 2027
SSBF, Pune	17 Jan 2027	Not published	Not published

Sources: the admission calendars published on sibm.edu, siib.ac.in, sims.edu, sicsr.ac.in and ssbf.edu.in, checked 28 October 2026. * SCMHRD's dates are carried from a secondary report of its published schedule - confirm on scmhrd.edu before you rely on them. SIBM Pune's first merit list is dated 26 February 2027; SIIB's is 15 March 2027.

The two deadlines that catch people out

SIBM Pune and SCMHRD close programme registration on 12 December 2026 - the day before the first test. If you planned to decide your programmes after seeing how test one went, you will have missed both flagship Pune institutes.

SIMS closes on 11 January 2027, the day before the result. Its GE-PI is conducted online, and its schedule is the earliest of the group - 29 January.

Reading the map by city

Twelve of the seventeen institutes are in Pune. The rest sit in five other cities, and each of those campuses is built around a narrower programme mix - which matters, because the city shapes the recruiter list as much as the curriculum does.

City	Institutes	What the campus is built around
Pune	12	The full spread - general MBA, HR, international business, IT and analytics, operations, media, healthcare, banking, sports and food business
Nashik	1	Operations and supply chain, including a dual degree with Durham University Business School
Bengaluru	1	General MBA plus Business Analytics, in India's largest technology-labour market
Hyderabad	1	General MBA
Nagpur	1	General MBA plus Food and Agri Business Management
NOIDA	1	General MBA, serving the Delhi NCR market

Source: the institute and city list published on snaptest.org, checked 28 October 2026.

The full map

Institute	City	MBA programmes open through SNAP 2026
SIBM Pune	Pune	MBA; MBA (Innovation and Entrepreneurship); MBA (Human Resource Management and Integrated AI Analytics)
SCMHRD	Pune	MBA; MBA (Infrastructure Development and Management); MBA (Business Analytics)
SIIB	Pune	MBA (International Business); MBA (Agri Business); MBA (Sustainability Management)
SICSR	Pune	MBA (Information Technology); MBA (Digital Transformation)
SCIT	Pune	MBA (IT Business Management); MBA (Data Science and Data Analytics); MBA (Artificial Intelligence in Business)
SIDTM	Pune	MBA (Digital and Telecom Management)
SIMS	Pune	MBA
SIMC	Pune	MBA (Communication Management)
SIHS	Pune	MBA (Hospital and Healthcare Management)
SSBF	Pune	MBA (Banking and Finance); dual degrees with Aston University (UK) and Macquarie University (Australia)
SSSS	Pune	MBA (Sports Management)
SSCANS	Pune	MBA (Food Technology and Food Enterprise Management)
SIOM	Nashik	MBA (Operations and Supply Chain Management); MBA (Agri Operations Management); MBA (Operations Management), dual degree with Durham University Business School (UK)
SIBM Bengaluru	Bengaluru	MBA; MBA (Business Analytics)
SIBM Hyderabad	Hyderabad	MBA
SIBM Nagpur	Nagpur	MBA; MBA (Food and Agri Business Management)
SIBM Noida	NOIDA	MBA

Source: the programme list published on snaptest.org, checked 28 October 2026. Programme names and intakes change; confirm on the institute's own admissions page before you pay a programme fee.

18 · THE PORTFOLIO

Choosing programmes: the Rs 1,000 decision

Each programme costs Rs 1,000 plus taxes, and each one buys a separate place in a separate merit queue. Paying for ten programmes is not diligence; it is a way of avoiding the decision about what you actually want to study.

A portfolio that makes sense

1. **One flagship you would take today.** SIBM Pune or SCMHRD MBA, SIIB International Business, or the closest thing to your goal.
2. **One programme matched to your background.** Engineering and IT candidates: SCIT or SICSR. Commerce and finance: SSBF. Defence families: SIMS. Operations: SIOM. Healthcare: SIHS.
3. **One programme with a different selection dynamic.** A smaller institute where the competition per seat is different from the flagship - this is where a good score converts into a call.

4 **Nothing you cannot explain in one sentence.** If you cannot say why you applied to a programme, you will be asked that exact question at the interview.

Eligibility differences that decide your list

Programme	Eligibility beyond the 50% / 45% baseline
SNAP-wide baseline	Graduate in any discipline, minimum 50% (45% for SC/ST). Final-year students may apply, subject to meeting the requirement.
SCMHRD MBA (Business Analytics)	Minimum two years of full-time work experience after graduation.
SCMHRD MBA (Infrastructure Development and Management)	Engineering, architecture or planning degree; otherwise any bachelor's degree plus at least 12 months of work experience in infrastructure, real estate, energy, logistics or an allied sector.
SCIT MBA programmes	Any faculty, but candidates are expected to be conversant with IT.
SIMS MBA	80% of seats are reserved for defence personnel and their dependants; general candidates compete for the remainder.
SIIB MBA programmes	240 seats across the three programmes; final-year students may apply.

Sources: the programme structure documents published by SCMHRD and SIMS, SCIT's admissions FAQ, SIIB's admissions FAQ, and SIU's published eligibility statement, checked 28 October 2026.

A rule for candidates with work experience

If you have two or more years of experience, the analytics and operations programmes are not a fallback - they are often the better return, because the cohort, the recruiters and the curriculum assume you have already worked. Read the eligibility table before you fall in love with a flagship.

19 · THE MONEY

Fees, ROI and what to ask before you pay

SNAP costs Rs 12,567 at the top end. The programme behind it costs between roughly Rs 6.5 lakh and Rs 25 lakh for two years. That ratio is why the programme decision deserves more of your attention than the test fee.

Published fee structures, for calibration

Programme	Academic fee p.a.	Deposit	Two-year outlay
SCMHRD MBA	Rs 12,30,000	Rs 20,000	Rs 24,80,000
SCMHRD MBA (Business Analytics)	Rs 9,28,000	Rs 20,000	Rs 18,76,000
SIMS MBA - Open category	Rs 3,17,700	Rs 20,000	Rs 6,55,400
SIMS MBA - Defence category	Rs 6,52,000	Rs 20,000	Rs 13,24,000
SIMS MBA - Industry sponsored	Rs 9,36,000	Rs 20,000	Rs 18,92,000

Figures from the approved programme structure documents for the 2025-27 batch published by SCMHRD and SIMS. Two-year outlay = two years of academic fee plus the one-time institute deposit, before hostel, mess and travel. Fees for the 2027-29 batch will be published separately - treat these as calibration, not as a quote.

Notice what the SIMS table shows

At SIMS, the Open-category fee is roughly half the Defence-category fee, and a third of the Industry-sponsored fee. The same classroom, the same degree, three different prices depending on the seat you hold. Fee structures in Indian management education are not uniform across categories, and the difference can exceed Rs 12 lakh over two years.

Five questions to ask before you accept a seat

1. What is the total cost for two years, including hostel, mess, laptop, international immersion and the deposit - in one number?
2. What percentage of the batch was placed last year, and what is the median package rather than the highest?
3. Is the programme AICTE-approved or UGC-recognised as a degree, and what exactly will the certificate say?
4. What happens to my deposit if I withdraw before the programme starts?
5. Which companies recruited from this specific programme, not from the institute as a whole, in the last two cycles?

The arithmetic that matters more than the ranking

A Rs 24.8 lakh two-year outlay against a Rs 12 lakh median package is a different decision from a Rs 6.5 lakh outlay against an Rs 8 lakh package, even if the first institute ranks higher. Write both numbers down before the merit list arrives - the decision is made in a week, and it is not a good week to start doing arithmetic.

20 · THE OTHER 50 MARKS

After the result: the composite score

The result is declared on 12 January 2027 and stays downloadable until 12 February 2027. What arrives is a percentile, not a rank list - and it is only half of what the institutes use.

How the merit list is built

Every Symbiosis institute publishes the same structure: your SNAP performance scaled to 50 marks, Group Exercise 10 marks, Personal Interaction 40 marks. The exact scaling method from raw score or percentile to 50 marks is not published, so treat any worked example as illustration rather than formula.

Component	Marks	What it rewards
SNAP performance (scaled)	50	Aptitude, accuracy and speed on the day
Group Exercise	10	Teamwork, listening, contribution, conduct under observation
Personal Interaction	40	Motivation, self-awareness, programme fit, communication
Total	100	-

The consequence nobody internalises early enough

Forty per cent of the merit score is decided in a room in February. A candidate 4 marks behind on the SNAP component needs only 4 of the 40 interview marks to close the gap - which is one well-prepared answer about why they chose that programme. Conversely, a strong percentile with a weak interview loses seats every single year.

What to do in the twelve days between result and shortlist

Day 1: download and print the scorecard. You need it for every institute process, and it is only available until 12 February 2027.

Days 2-4: write three answers in full - why an MBA, why this programme, why you. Every interview opens with one of them.

Days 5-8: two mock interviews with someone who will interrupt you. Interruptions are the part nobody rehearses.

Days 9-12: read one business story a day and form an opinion on it in three sentences. Group exercises and interviews both test whether you have opinions.

21 · THE ROOM

GE-PI: the other 50 marks

Institutes describe what they assess in plain language. SIIB lists communication and presentation, teamwork and collaboration, leadership, critical and analytical thinking, the ability to work under pressure, and listening and interpersonal skills. SCIT runs a GE followed by a written ability test built on current trends and recent news. SIMS conducts its GE-PI entirely online.

The Group Exercise, decoded

A group exercise is not a debate and it is not a race to speak first. It is an observation of how you behave when eleven other people also want the floor. The behaviours that score are unglamorous: bringing a quiet person in, summarising the group's position accurately, conceding a point when someone is right, and keeping the group on the actual question.

Exercise format	What they watch for	One thing to do
Case discussion	Structure, prioritisation, commercial sense	Propose a framework in the first 90 seconds
Group task with material	Coordination, role clarity, time discipline	Take the timekeeper role and hold it
Ranking or prioritisation task	Reasoning, willingness to be persuaded	State your criterion before your ranking
Abstract topic	Creativity with structure	Give one example, then one rule
Written ability test	Clarity, brevity, point of view	Three paragraphs: position, reason, example

The Personal Interview: twenty questions to prepare in writing

1. Tell me about yourself - in 90 seconds, ending at why you are here.
2. Why an MBA, and why now rather than two years ago?
3. Why this programme, specifically? Name a course or a faculty interest.
4. Why Symbiosis rather than another institute?
5. What will you contribute to this cohort?
6. Describe a time you disagreed with a manager or a professor. What did you do?
7. Tell me about a failure and what changed in you afterwards.
8. What is the last book or long article you finished, and what did you take from it?
9. What do you think of the current state of your industry?
10. Which company would you most like to work for, and in what role?
11. What is your five-year plan, and what is the first job that gets you there?
12. What is your biggest weakness - and what have you actually done about it?
13. How will you fund two years of study?
14. What would you do if you did not get a seat this year?
15. Give me an example of a decision you made with incomplete information.
16. What is an ethical dilemma you have faced at work or college?

17 What does integrity mean in a manager's daily work?

18 Which part of the SNAP paper did you find hardest, and why?

19 What question should I have asked you that I did not?

20 Do you have anything to add that we have not covered?

The one answer that separates candidates

'Why this programme' is where most interviews are won or lost, and it is the easiest to prepare. Learn two course names, one specialisation, and one thing the institute does that another does not - then connect it to a job you can name. Generic enthusiasm for 'the Symbiosis ecosystem' reads exactly as prepared as it is.

22 · THE CENTRE

Exam day: the checklist

The rules below come from the SNAP 2026 bulletin and SIU's published guidelines. They are not advisory. Candidates are turned away every year for the photograph, the printout colour and the arrival time.

Carry exactly this

- A colour printout of your admit card, with a recent passport-size colour photograph pasted in the space provided. The photograph must be less than six months old.
- One original photo identity document - passport, driving licence, voter ID, PAN card, Aadhaar or college ID. A soft copy on your phone is not accepted.
- A simple ballpoint pen. A transparent water bottle. Personal sanitiser up to 50 ml if you use one.

Leave behind

Mobile phones, calculators, watch calculators, alarm clocks, digital watches with memory or built-in calculators, smartwatches, fitness bands, smart glasses and similar wearables, laptops, cameras, earphones, and any books, notes or loose paper. There is no locker facility, and SIU states it is not responsible for lost belongings.

The timeline on the day

When	What
About 90 minutes before your slot	Reach the centre. Reporting time is printed on your admit card - follow that, not a general rule.
About 30 minutes before	Occupy your assigned seat. Security frisking and document verification happen in between.
At the slot start	Gates close. Candidates are not allowed into the centre after the test has started, for any reason.
60 minutes	The paper. You may attempt sections in any order.
After submission	You cannot re-enter the hall. Get your admit card stamped before you leave.

The two documents that decide your February

Your admit card will be authenticated and stamped by the invigilator. That stamped card is required for the GE-PI stage, and the bulletin states plainly that a duplicate will not be issued if it is lost. Keep it with your scorecard until the admission process is over.

The scorecard, downloadable from 12 January 2027, is equally non-negotiable - and it is only available until 12 February 2027. Print it the week it appears.

If you have a disability

PwD candidates receive compensatory time of 20 minutes per hour, and are asked to upload their supporting documents at the registration stage. Upload them when you register, not in December.

23 · THE TAPER

The last 48 hours

The two days before a test are not for learning. They are for arriving at the centre rested, documented and calm. Here is the schedule that does that.

When	Do	Do not
Two days before	One 20-question mixed set, the formula sheet, the Ethics method, normal sleep	Start a new topic or take a full mock
Morning before	Re-read your error log's last three entries; confirm the centre address and travel time	Discuss the paper with other candidates
Afternoon before	Print the admit card in colour, paste the photograph, keep the original ID in the bag	Rely on a printout made weeks ago
Evening before	Light revision of the formula card; pack the bag; sleep by your usual time	Study past midnight or take a sleeping pill you have never used
Morning of the test	Light breakfast, reach the centre about 90 minutes before your slot	Carry a phone, smartwatch or notes into the centre
In the hall	Use the first minute to plan your section order; keep two minutes as buffer	Spend more than 90 seconds on any single question
After the paper	Write your estimate within two hours, then stop analysing	Rebuild the paper from memory for three days

Between the three tests

If you are sitting more than one test, the days between are for one thing: the error log. Take one sectional in your weakest section, review the log, and keep your clock habit alive. Do not restart the syllabus - there are six days between 13 and 19 December, and six days of new material is six days of confusion.

Also: your second and third admit cards appear on 11 and 18 December. Download them on the day they release, not the night before.

24 · THE BOUNDARIES

Scams, agents and refunds

Every admission season produces people selling certainty. SIU's own FAQ answers the question directly: no admission agent can guarantee a seat, admissions are merit-based, no donation or capitation fee is required, and candidates should not rely on any assurance from an individual or outside agency.

What is true about money

- The SNAP test fee and the programme registration fee are both non-refundable and non-transferable. That is stated in the bulletin, not buried in a footer.
- Paying the test fee alone does not make you eligible for shortlisting in any programme, regardless of your score.
- Official communication comes only from info@snaptest.org and no-reply@system.snaptest.org, plus the SNAP portal itself.
- Scores published by SIU are final and not open to appeal or revaluation.

The three approaches to refuse

1. Anyone offering a confirmed seat, a management quota or an internal reference for a fee. SIU's FAQ is explicit that this does not exist.
2. Anyone asking you to pay a programme fee into a personal account, a UPI handle or a wallet. Programme fees are paid on the SNAP portal only.
3. Anyone selling 'guaranteed SNAP 2026 question papers' or 'leaked sets'. The paper is computer-based with uniquely arranged questions, and using leaked material would disqualify you from all SIU programmes retrospectively - including after admission.

What to do if a payment goes wrong

Raise a query ticket from the SNAP portal using your SNAP ID - the bulletin says generating a ticket is essential to resolving a query. Keep the payment reference, the bank statement line and the portal screenshot together in one folder. For disputes with the Test Secretariat, the bulletin names registrar@siu.edu.in as the first escalation and the University Ombudsman as the second.

25 · THE AUDIT

Twelve mistakes that cost marks

Each of these appears in the error log of nearly every candidate who underperforms their practice scores. Read the list once a week until the paper.

1. **Registering late.** Test city and date are first come, first served. Late registration can mean a five-hour journey the night before the paper.
2. **Paying only the test fee.** No programme fee, no consideration for that programme. It is the most expensive Rs 1,000 a candidate never spends.
3. **Booking three attempts and preparing for one.** The third attempt is only an asset if you analyse the first two.
4. **Treating General English as free marks.** Ten marks lost to carelessness is the same as ten marks lost to ignorance.
5. **Ignoring Data Sufficiency.** These are the cheapest marks in the Quantitative block and the most commonly skipped.
6. **Reading the whole paper before starting.** Three minutes of a sixty-minute paper, spent on information you will forget.
7. **Leaving questions blank.** At a 0.25 penalty on four options, a blank is a guaranteed zero against a positive expectation.

8 **Spending four minutes on one puzzle.** The single largest source of lost marks in the reasoning section.

9 **Not preparing for Ethics because it is new.** Everyone else is in the same position - which is exactly why preparation pays here more than anywhere else.

10 **Taking a full mock the day before the test.** Fatigue on the day costs more than the mock adds.

11 **Arriving without a colour printout.** The bulletin requires a printed admit card with a pasted photograph. Black and white is not accepted.

12 **Stopping at the percentile.** Forty per cent of the merit score is decided in an interview in February, and most candidates start preparing for it in February.

26 · THE CARD

Your one-page action card

Print this page. Put it where you will see it every morning.

Today

Open snaptest.org and check that your registration is complete: test dates chosen, programme list paid for, photograph uploaded, category documents uploaded if applicable.

Write down your target: the programmes you are applying to, and the section you will fix first.

This week

Sit one diagnostic full mock at 55 minutes and fill the error log from section 11.

Start the Ethics week from section 9 - it is ten marks and it takes seven days.

By 24 November

Every payment made. Nothing on the portal is editable after 25 November.

Programme registration for SIBM Pune and SCMHRD closed on 12 December last cycle - if those are on your list, treat early December as your real deadline.

By 13 December

Six analysed mocks, one formula sheet written from memory, one Ethics method rehearsed against the clock.

Admit card printed in colour on 7 December, photograph pasted, original photo ID kept ready, centre located a day in advance.

After 12 January 2027

Print the scorecard before 12 February 2027. Prepare the twenty interview answers before the shortlist, not after it.

46	25 NOV	3	50+10+40
DAYS TO TEST 1	LAST DAY TO REGISTER	ATTEMPTS, BEST COUNTS	MERIT WEIGHTAGE

APPENDIX

Sources

Every date, fee, weightage and rule in this playbook was checked against the following official sources on 28 October 2026. Figures that could not be verified from an official source are either marked as secondary or left out.

Source	What it established
SNAP 2026 Bulletin, Symbiosis International (Deemed University), snaptest.org	Registration window, three test dates, admit card dates, result date, section structure, fees, admit card and exam-day rules, PwD compensatory time, non-refundability, score validity
snaptest.org - SNAP 2026 official site and FAQ	17 institutes, 32 programmes, six cities, 79 test cities, best-of-three with no normalisation, eligibility baseline, fee structure, no-agent warning
snaptest.org - exam pattern and guidelines pages	Section-wise question and mark distribution, attempt-any-order rule, photo ID list, prohibited items
sibm.edu - MBA important dates	SIBM Pune programme registration close, shortlist, GE-PI, merit list and commencement dates
siib.ac.in and crackit.siib.ac.in - admission calendar and FAQ	SIIB registration close, shortlist, GE-PI dates, eligibility, two-step application, what GE-PI assesses
sims.edu - admission procedure and approved programme structure	SIMS dates, online GE-PI, 80% defence reservation, published fee structure
sicsr.ac.in and admission.sicsr.ac.in - admission schedule and process	SICSR dates and programme names
ssbf.edu.in - how to apply, 2027-28 cycle	SSBF registration deadline and fee steps
scit.edu - admissions FAQ	SCIT programme names, 180 seats, GE-PIWAT on SNAP percentile, eligibility
scmhrd.edu - approved programme structure documents	SCMHRD selection weightage, eligibility rules for Business Analytics and Infrastructure programmes, published fee structure
SIU press coverage of the 2026 pattern change (Careers360, 21 August 2026)	The new Ethics, Morality and Values section, 25% negative marking, four options, composite score of 50+10+40, early-registration benefits

This playbook is an independent study guide. It is not published by, endorsed by or affiliated with Symbiosis International (Deemed University). Dates and fees change; the institute's own website and the SNAP bulletin are always the final authority.